

Modern Clipboard — Quick Start Guide

Version 1.2

Step 1 — The Menu Bar Icon

Modern Clipboard runs as a menu bar application. After it launches, its icon appears in the menu bar at the top-right of the screen. The app has no Dock icon; all functions are accessed from the menu bar icon and the keyboard shortcuts described in this guide.

Note: Modern Clipboard is configured to launch automatically at login. To disable this, open **Preferences** → **General** and turn off **Launch Modern Clipboard at login**.

Step 2 — Grant Accessibility Permission

Modern Clipboard needs Accessibility permission to paste on your behalf.

When prompted, click **Open Accessibility Settings** → find **Modern Clipboard** → toggle it **on**.

*Missed the prompt? Open the menu bar icon → **Preferences** → **General** → click **Open Accessibility Settings**.*

Step 3 — Copy Something

Copy any text as you normally would (⌘C, i.e. Command-C). Modern Clipboard captures it automatically — no action needed.

Step 4 — Paste from History

Press ⇧⌘V (Shift-Command-V) from anywhere to open the history popup.

Key	What it does
↓ / ↑	Move between items
→ / ←	Open a folder · go back
↵ (Return)	Paste the selected item
1 – 9, 0	Instantly paste items 1–10 (0 = the 10th)
Esc (Escape)	Close without pasting

The popup closes and pastes into whatever app you were using.

Tip: Copied formatting (bold, links, colors) is always preserved and pasted back by default. Want it to match the destination's existing style instead? Hold ⌥ **Option** (configurable) while pasting from the popup — this pastes plain text that takes on the formatting already in place where you're pasting.

Step 4.5 — Clear Your History

Want to wipe everything you've copied? Open **Preferences** → **General**, then click **Clear Clipboard History...** in the Clipboard History section to remove all saved items at once.

Step 5 — Create a Snippet

Snippets are text blocks you save once and reuse forever — great for signatures, templates, or common replies.

1. Press **⇧⌘S** (Shift-Command-S) to open the snippets popup.
2. Click **Edit Snippets...** below the folder list to open the snippet editor.
3. Click **+** in the left column to create a folder.
4. Select your folder, then click **+** in the middle column to add a snippet.
5. Enter a title and your text, then click **Save**.

Press **⇧⌘S** (Shift-Command-S) anywhere to open your snippets and paste one.

Step 6 — Quick Snippets (Paste with One Key)

At the top of your snippets you'll find a special ⚡ **Quick Snippets** folder. It holds up to **10** snippets, each mapped to a number key so you can paste it the instant the popup opens — no arrow keys, no clicking.

When you press **⇧⌘S**, the Quick Snippets folder opens automatically. Just press the number next to a snippet to paste it:

Key	Pastes
1 – 9, 0	Paste Quick Snippet 1–10 (0 = the 10th)
↵ (Return)	The selected snippet
Esc (Escape)	Close without pasting

To set them up, open **Edit Snippets...** and select the ⚡ **Quick Snippets** folder. It comes pre-filled with a few examples — replace them with your own most-used text. Add up to 10; the folder can't be deleted, and slot **10** is always the **0** key.

***Tip:** Prefer that the Quick Snippets folder not open automatically? Turn off **Auto-open Quick Snippets folder** in **Preferences** → **General** (Snippets section). Your other folders are always one arrow-key away.*

Step 7 — Exclude Sensitive Apps

Keep clipboard contents from password managers and other sensitive apps out of your history entirely.

1. Open **Preferences** → **Exclude Apps**.
2. Click **+** and choose an app, or click **Auto-exclude known password managers** to add common ones (1Password, Bitwarden, LastPass, and more) automatically.
3. Anything copied in an excluded app never enters the clipboard history.

That's it!

Action	Shortcut	
Open clipboard history	⇧⌘V	Shift-Command-V
Open snippets	⇧⌘S	Shift-Command-S

Ran into a problem or have an idea? Open **Preferences** → **Help** to report a bug, request a feature, or export diagnostics.